

God's Purpose in Giving the Law

Glory. Open to Romans, the end of the first chapter, and put a marker in Second Corinthians 3 and Galatians 3 and 4. Hallelujah.

We are going into a time of teaching where we divide the law, the born-again experience, and eventually the difference between the law, the born-again experience, and the promise God made to Abraham.

One reason the book of Romans was locked up to me was the teaching I had received from some great teachers that Romans 7 was simply a Christian having problems with his flesh:

"The good that I would I do not, and the evil that I would not, that I do."

They taught that this was just a believer having problems with his flesh. I believed that for many years. I would fluctuate. I would believe it for a while, then see something that seemed to convince me the other way, that it was an unregenerated man, particularly a Jew who had received the law and could not keep it.

When it finally settled in my spirit that Romans 7 is an unregenerated Jew who received the law and could not keep it, I crossed a line. Once I received that for good on the inside of my spirit, I was able to back up to Romans and take it all the way through. Chapter after chapter began to open.

It also opened complicated verses in Galatians and Second Corinthians, verses that had been hard for me to understand. They are the kind of verses nobody ever preaches on. They sit there lonely. Nobody reads them unless they are reading through the Bible.

With all those exciting verses, like "The works that I do shall ye do also," "Nothing shall be impossible to him that believeth," and "Nothing shall be impossible unto you," I found what I needed to see them come to pass more in the verses nobody teaches on than in the verses everybody teaches on.

Gary talked about Jesus saying:

"It is expedient for you that I go away: for if I go not away, the Comforter will not come."

Gary said, "Lord, I think it would have been better if You stayed. If Your headquarters were in Jerusalem, at least I could take my mother there if she were dying of disease. Even if it took three months or a year to get an appointment, I would know that when I took her there, she would be healed."

So when Jesus said, "The works I do shall ye do also," He meant it. In our inheritance, everything He made available to the Church is ours. These signs will follow those who believe: they will cast out devils, lay hands on the sick, and speak with new tongues. I think our generation needs signs and wonders as much as any generation ever has.

There is a way into that full inheritance, but obviously it is not walking down the traditional limb. If what I am doing is not producing that, I should be smart enough to change what I am doing.

Well, I have.

When He put me on this Born-Again Trail, I took by faith what He told me until I looked down that path the first time. The gift of faith seemed to drop on me. For that little period of time, I felt like I had God's faith. I was looking at things the way He looks at them. He does not look at things like we do; they are not that kind of problem to Him.

For a short time, I knew that I knew that I knew. Looking through God's eyes, I could have it all if I would just walk it out.

When I first began to mention the Born-Again Trail, I had seen it but could not explain it. I knew the Holy Ghost had to back up behind what happened to me in Christ. That is the only thing He could bring forward. It is the only thing He is qualified and authorized to bring forward.

There are many limbs we have crawled out on that He is not in. Those are the limbs that need to be purged. Jesus said:

"Every branch in me that beareth not fruit he taketh away:
and every branch that beareth fruit, he purgeth it, that it may bring forth more fruit."

It is to your advantage that He cut off fruitless branches because they take your time, wrong believing, and life. They produce dead fruit or no fruit. If you bear fruit, He will purge you so you bear more. He wants everything that Christ is to flow through the maximum of what you are.

When the Holy Spirit backs up behind that born-again experience and I let Him bring forward what I have become in my spirit, that is when He can advance my life.

He gave us things to come forward with. I have something to offer my mind, will, intellect, and emotions to: the Word of God. I have something to offer my spirit to: praying in the Holy Ghost and continual meditation in His Word.

As He brings forth everything I have been made in Christ, my inheritance begins to materialize. That is when you cannot be stopped. You are going to advance. It does not matter who you are married to, who you are not married to, what your circumstances are, who you are, what nation you are in, or what background you have. Your inheritance is from another world.

Glory be to God. He has taken it out of this one. You can take care of everybody around you because you have faith and your Father is God.

Hallelujah.

Traditional limbs of men have fallen far short of His glory. Now that I am beginning to understand this more and more, He is opening more and more chapters.

Right now I know He wants me to give you an understanding of the law so it can give you an understanding of the verses we are about to explore. It will finally give you an understanding that He really has set you free from sin and all its friends. Sin really does not have dominion over you.

That is such a good statement in the head. But to really understand that sin has lost dominion, and to understand the degree to which it has lost dominion, you have to understand the turn of covenant for the Jew and his freedom from the law. For us, He simply says, "Sin shall not have dominion over you."

The right standing of the law can now be fulfilled in us who walk not after the flesh but after the Spirit:

"For what the law could not do, in that it was weak through the flesh,
God sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh,
and for sin, condemned sin in the flesh:
That the righteousness of the law might be fulfilled in us,
who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit."

The whole reason for the law was to school a spiritually dead man to the fact that he could not quit sinning and needed a Redeemer.

When covenants changed, you might as well know you are free. Sin does not have dominion over you. It cannot make you do anything you do not want to do. It cannot conquer you, and neither can any of its friends: poverty, sickness, disease, or depression. None of them have dominion over you.

That is the first thing the Holy Ghost backs up and gets behind. He says, "If you will let Me bring this forward, you are going to find out it does not have dominion over you."

In Romans 1, Paul describes the destruction of the early world, the world in general, the nations, and the sin they were in. The destruction of the early world was caused by the epitome of idolatry, including homosexuality. All flesh went its own way, Satan's way. God destroyed the world and reduced it to one family. You have to admit that when Noah came off the ark, the knowledge of God was in the whole earth.

Now Paul is teaching salvation. Some Jews were trying to go back under the law and trying to get Gentiles to go with them. In Antioch, when Peter was there, certain men came from James in Jerusalem. Peter got caught up in dissimulation with the Jews, and the other Jews, including Barnabas, went along with him. That also spread to the Galatian church.

Paul spent much of his time trying to get the foundation back to the Church.

I firmly believe Paul was born out of due season because after the other apostles, who had walked with Jesus in His natural life, began drifting back under the law, Paul was brought on the scene. He said, "I received this from no man. It was given to me by the Lord Jesus Christ."

He was an apostle born out of due season, and just in time, because even Peter and James were beginning to go back under the law. Paul came on the scene, put the brakes on the whole thing, and gave the Church her foundation back.

So in Romans, he is reasoning with Jews who were attempting to go back under the law, just as they were in Galatians. If you do not understand the problem an epistle is addressing, the revelation stays hidden. Once you understand the problem, the revelation begins to flow, and you want to talk about freedom.

Romans 1:28-32 says:

"And even as they did not like to retain God in their knowledge,
God gave them over to a reprobate mind,
to do those things which are not convenient;
Being filled with all unrighteousness, fornication, wickedness, covetousness, maliciousness;
full of envy, murder, debate, deceit, malignity;
whisperers, backbiters, haters of God, despiteful, proud, boasters,
inventors of evil things, disobedient to parents,
without understanding, covenantbreakers, without natural affection, implacable,
unmerciful:
Who knowing the judgment of God,
that they which commit such things are worthy of death,
not only do the same, but have pleasure in them that do them."

Then Romans 2:1 says:

"Therefore thou art inexcusable, O man, whosoever thou art that judgest:
for wherein thou judgest another, thou condemnest thyself;
for thou that judgest doest the same things."

Paul is speaking to Jews who were attempting to go back under the law. He says, "This is why the judgment of God came on the early world. You are judging another man because he has not received salvation as you think it comes through the law, yet you do the same things."

The law does not save you. If you do the same things, the same judgment that came upon them will come upon you.

Romans 2:14-16 says:

"For when the Gentiles, which have not the law, do by nature the things contained in the law, these, having not the law, are a law unto themselves:
Which show the work of the law written in their hearts,
their conscience also bearing witness,
and their thoughts the mean while accusing or else excusing one another;
In the day when God shall judge the secrets of men by Jesus Christ according to my gospel."

The law said, "Thou shalt not commit adultery." Now the Gentile gets born again, and because he has a new nature, sin has lost dominion over him. He does not have to do the things God says he should not do.

Paul is saying, "The Gentiles are fulfilling what you could not do, even though you had circumcision. You tried to do it and could not, and now they are doing it. So is not their uncircumcision made circumcision because they are keeping a law you could not keep?"

He continues in Romans 2:17-24:

"Behold, thou art called a Jew, and retest in the law,
and makest thy boast of God,
And knowest his will,
and approvest the things that are more excellent,
being instructed out of the law;
And art confident that thou thyself art a guide of the blind,
a light of them which are in darkness,
An instructor of the foolish,
a teacher of babes,
which hast the form of knowledge and of the truth in the law.
Thou therefore which teachest another, teachest thou not thyself?
thou that preachest a man should not steal, dost thou steal?
Thou that sayest a man should not commit adultery, dost thou commit adultery?
thou that abhorrest idols, dost thou commit sacrilege?
Thou that makest thy boast of the law, through breaking the law dishonourest thou God?
For the name of God is blasphemed among the Gentiles through you, as it is written."

Then Romans 2:25-29 says:

"For circumcision verily profiteth, if thou keep the law:
but if thou be a breaker of the law, thy circumcision is made uncircumcision.
Therefore if the uncircumcision keep the righteousness of the law,
shall not his uncircumcision be counted for circumcision?
And shall not uncircumcision which is by nature,
if it fulfil the law,
judge thee, who by the letter and circumcision dost transgress the law?
For he is not a Jew, which is one outwardly;
neither is that circumcision, which is outward in the flesh:
But he is a Jew, which is one inwardly;
and circumcision is that of the heart, in the spirit, and not in the letter;
whose praise is not of men, but of God."

Who is a Jew? I am, because I have been circumcised in spirit. Hallelujah.

Now the Jew has a question. He is standing there thinking, "Then what good did it do to be one of the promised people? What good did it do to be a Jew? If these swine-eating Gentiles are going to inherit the blessings, what did it profit us to keep the law?"

You know how spiritually dead man is: "We are special, and you are slime."

Romans 3:1-2 says:

"What advantage then hath the Jew?
or what profit is there of circumcision?
Much every way:
chiefly, because that unto them were committed the oracles of God."

God had to get Jesus into the earth. He had to choose somebody to talk to. He had to give the Word to somebody. He picked Abraham, who grew into a nation. The main advantage of the Jew was that God committed the oracles of God to them.

Romans 3:19-20 says:

"Now we know that what things soever the law saith,
it saith to them who are under the law:
that every mouth may be stopped,
and all the world may become guilty before God.
Therefore by the deeds of the law there shall no flesh be justified in his sight:
for by the law is the knowledge of sin."

What the law says, it says to those under the law, the Jews, so every mouth may be stopped and the whole world become guilty before God.

Every nation on earth was as spiritually dead as a doornail. God had to deliver the oracles to somebody. So He reached down, took the nation of Israel, Abraham's seed, and held them in His hands. He said, "I want you to keep the law. Thou shalt not commit adultery. Thou shalt not bear false witness. Thou shalt have no other gods before Me."

He gave them the law, fully knowing they could not keep it. Nobody could.

Why did He give it? So He could judge the whole world and declare the whole world guilty. He said, "Gentile nations, I gave this law to the Jew, and they could not keep it. If they cannot keep it, you cannot keep it."

He declared both Jew and Gentile under sin so He could lay the sins of the whole world on one Man, Jesus Christ.

The purpose of the law was the knowledge of sin. A spiritually dead man did not know he was spiritually dead. God had to give him the law to show him he was dead. The law became our schoolmaster to lead us to Christ.

By Adam's transgression, sin entered into the world and death by sin. Every human being was born spiritually dead. You do not know you are dead until the law tells you. You cannot know anything else because you only know by the spirit that is in you.

First Corinthians says:

"What man knoweth the things of a man, save the spirit of man which is in him?"

The only things spiritually dead men can know are the things of spiritually dead men. You have no way of knowing anything else. That is why God sent the schoolmaster.

Romans 7:7 says:

"What shall we say then? Is the law sin? God forbid.
Nay, I had not known sin, but by the law:
for I had not known lust, except the law had said, Thou shalt not covet."

Romans 7:8-11 says:

"But sin, taking occasion by the commandment, wrought in me all manner of concupiscence.
For without the law sin was dead.
For I was alive without the law once:
but when the commandment came, sin revived, and I died.
And the commandment, which was ordained to life, I found to be unto death.
For sin, taking occasion by the commandment, deceived me, and by it slew me."

When Paul says, "I was alive without the law once, but when the commandment came, sin revived and I died," he is not talking about himself before the age of accountability. He is hypothetically speaking in the place of every Jew who received the law and could not keep it.

He is saying, "When I was sin, I did not know I was sin. I did not know I was doing anything wrong. Because I had no conscience in that sense, it made no difference if I killed a race of people one day and sat down to dinner the next. When you have no conscience, you do not know you are spiritually dead."

Then God comes along and says, "Thou shalt not." You try to stop and find out you had a master the whole time and did not know it. That master was sin.

Romans 7:12-14 says:

"Wherefore the law is holy, and the commandment holy, and just, and good.
Was then that which is good made death unto me? God forbid.
But sin, that it might appear sin,
working death in me by that which is good;
that sin by the commandment might become exceeding sinful.
For we know that the law is spiritual:
but I am carnal, sold under sin."

Certainly the law is spiritual. "Thou shalt not commit adultery." "Thou shalt not bear false witness." But Paul says, "I am carnal. My forefather Adam sold me under sin."

Romans 7:15-24 continues:

"For that which I do I allow not:
for what I would, that do I not;
but what I hate, that do I.
If then I do that which I would not, I consent unto the law that it is good.
Now then it is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me.
For I know that in me, that is, in my flesh, dwelleth no good thing:
for to will is present with me;
but how to perform that which is good I find not.
For the good that I would I do not:
but the evil which I would not, that I do.
Now if I do that I would not, it is no more I that do it,
but sin that dwelleth in me.
I find then a law, that, when I would do good, evil is present with me.
For I delight in the law of God after the inward man:
But I see another law in my members,
warring against the law of my mind,
and bringing me into captivity to the law of sin which is in my members.
O wretched man that I am! who shall deliver me from the body of this death?"

With his heart, the unregenerated Jew wants to serve God, but there is another law in his members bringing him into captivity. He cries, "Who is going to deliver me from this death that is in me?"

Then Paul answers:

"I thank God through Jesus Christ our Lord."

Romans 7 should conclude:

"So then with the mind I myself serve the law of God; but with the flesh the law of sin."

Then the covenant changes:

"There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus,
who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit."

"Condemnation" here is a judiciary word. It refers to a judge declaring a man guilty and sentencing him to death. In Romans 7, the spiritually dead man received a spiritual law and could not keep it. In Romans 8, the same person is born again, and the condemning sentence that judged him to death can no longer be carried out.

There is therefore now no condemnation to the born-again man and woman who walk no longer after the flesh but after the spirit.

Whenever you see the terminology in Romans 8, "not after the flesh, but after the Spirit," Paul is dividing the walk of an unregenerated man under the law from the walk of a man who has been born again.

Romans 7:5 says:

"For when we were in the flesh,
the motions of sins, which were by the law,
did work in our members to bring forth fruit unto death."

When were they in the flesh? When they were unregenerated and received the law, which worked death in them.

Romans 8:1 says there are now no condemning sentences from flesh, devil, world, or the judicial system of the law that can be carried out in me anymore because I do not walk after the flesh but after the law of the spirit of life. That new nature has set me free from the law of sin and death.

My God, "sin has no more dominion over me" takes on new meaning.

The first time the Holy Spirit is mentioned in Romans 8 is verse 16:

"The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit, that we are the children of God."

The Holy Ghost bears witness with our spirit.

Some think the Holy Spirit is mentioned in verse 15:

"For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear;
but ye have received the Spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, Abba, Father."

But the "spirit of adoption" is not the Holy Ghost. The Holy Ghost was never adopted. I am not crying "Abba, Father" by Him becoming my father. I am the one who was adopted.

Paul says, "You have received the spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, Abba, Father." Then in verse 16 he says the Holy Spirit bears witness with our spirit that we are children of God.

In First Corinthians 2, Paul says the same thing another way:

"Now we have received, not the spirit of the world,
but the spirit which is of God;
that we might know the things that are freely given to us of God."

In Romans, he says, "You have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear, but the spirit of adoption." In Corinthians, he says, "You have not received the spirit of the world, but the spirit which is of God." Both are referring to your born-again spirit.

There is only one Greek word for spirit. It is the same word used for the Spirit of God and the spirit of man. The only way to tell the difference is the sentence structure.

Now the Holy Ghost itself bears witness with your spirit that you are His child. What does He bear witness to? Romans 8:17 says:

"And if children, then heirs;
heirs of God, and joint-heirs with Christ;
if so be that we suffer with him, that we may be also glorified together."

The Holy Spirit bears witness that we are children, heirs of God, and joint-heirs with Christ.

In Corinthians, Paul says the Holy Spirit teaches the things of God to our new nature, spiritual to spiritual. In Romans, he simply says the Spirit bears witness with our spirit that we are children and heirs.

Hallelujah.

You do not have to get up in God's face and scream at Him. You have a covenant. Your covenant was actually fulfilled in Abraham. Then when Jesus was delivered to the world, you went from having to cut a contract to becoming a son.

How many of your children have ever come to you with a contract to make sure you would feed them?

I am a son. Hallelujah. Adoption has taken place. I serve Him as a son, knowing I have full inheritance.

Do you think I storm the gates of heaven and threaten my Father? No, sir. I do not have to. I have inherited as a son.

My Father has a big heart. I tried to tell Him, "Father, You have a weakness. You keep taking in orphans. This whole world has been orphaned, and You keep wanting to take them all in. I have been looking at Your account, and I do not think You have enough money to feed them."

He says, "That is exactly why I am not giving it to you to feed them with. I have to find somebody I can trust it with. I am going to keep adopting children. If you want to get a yacht, get a yacht to go adopt them with. But if you want a yacht instead of adopting children, get out of My sight, you prodigal."

So the prodigal comes back home, and the father says, "Go get your elder brother. He is out in the field under law." The prodigal has come back and has his full inheritance restored. The father says, "Let us kill the fatted calf."

The older son says, "All these years I have never transgressed any commandment, and you never killed a fatted calf for me."

The father says, "Listen, son, all I have is yours. You have never known Me well enough to know I would have killed the fatted calf every day of your life if that is what you wanted. We have had relationship, but never fellowship."

Relationship is two fellows in the same ship because of the same gene pool. Fellowship is two fellows in the same ship because they want to be there.

Now, son, I know I have an inheritance.

Second Corinthians 3 talks about Moses coming down from the mountain with a veil over his face and giving the law, the Ten Commandments.

Second Corinthians 3:7 says:

"But if the ministration of death, written and engraven in stones, was glorious..."

What did Paul call the law? He called the Ten Commandments the ministration of death. Why? Because they were spiritually dead and could not keep it.

What did the veil cover? The veil was a type of spiritual death. They could not keep the law because the Ten Commandments were the righteousness of the law, virtually the description of the new nature, but it was cloaked by spiritual death. That is why they could not see it and could not keep it.

Second Corinthians 3:9 says:

"For if the ministration of condemnation be glory,
much more doth the ministration of righteousness exceed in glory."

Now Paul calls the giving of the Ten Commandments the ministration of condemnation. Why? Because the law was our schoolmaster to reveal that we were spiritually dead and guilty before God, so every mouth could be stopped and God could lay all sin, Jew and Gentile, on one Man, Jesus Christ.

Galatians 3:10 says:

"For as many as are of the works of the law are under the curse:
for it is written,
Cursed is every one that continueth not in all things which are written in the book of the law
to do them."

As many as are under the law are under the curse of the law. Why? Because cursed is everyone who does not continue in all things written in the law. It was impossible for them to continue in all those things. They could not keep the law. That was Paul's point.

He says, "I had not known covetousness except the law had said, Thou shalt not covet." God said, "Stop," and Paul found out he could not stop.

Galatians 3:11-13 says:

"But that no man is justified by the law in the sight of God, it is evident:
for, The just shall live by faith.
And the law is not of faith:
but, The man that doeth them shall live in them.
Christ hath redeemed us from the curse of the law,
being made a curse for us:
for it is written,
Cursed is every one that hangeth on a tree."

How could Jesus redeem us from the curse of the law? He was born under the law. If He was born under the law, He was obligated to fulfill the law.

Here is the good news:

"In him was life; and the life was the light of men."

He was the first Man to be born spiritually alive since Adam. He was born under the law, so He was the first Man with a nature qualified to keep the law. Before He was condemned under the law, He kept it to the fullness with absolute perfection.

Because He was spiritually alive, He could keep it. Then He turned to the Jew and said, "I am going to become the curse of the law."

Why?

Because none of them could keep the law. Jesus kept it. Then He took their sin into Himself and died under the penalty of the law to free those under the law so they might accept Jesus Christ.

As you know, I am a repeater rifle. We will be back into it.